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Fate's Edge: Campaign Guide Expansion

Advanced Tools and Techniques

Game Master Resources

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Large**Introduction: Evolving Your Campaign**

large**Beyond the Basics**

After running multiple sessions of Fate’s Edge, experienced Game Masters often seek tools to enhance campaign depth and player engagement. This expansion builds upon the core campaign generation tools with advanced techniques for evolving your story world and deepening mechanical integration.

large**Core Philosophy Reminder**

Remember that Fate’s Edge prioritizes collaborative storytelling over mechanical complexity. These advanced tools should enhance, not replace, the fundamental principles of narrativefirst gameplay, player agency, and meaningful consequences.

Advanced Campaign Generation

Evolving the Crown Spread

The Crown Spread provides an excellent foundation, but campaigns need to grow beyond their initial seed elements.

Seasonal Evolution Framework

- Winter (Establishment):** Root themes take hold, initial conflicts emerge
- Spring (Growth):** New elements sprout, alliances form, complications multiply
- Summer (Climax):** Peak conflicts, major revelations, critical choices
- Autumn (Harvest):** Consequences manifest, legacies established, new seeds planted

Expanding Drawn Elements

When a Crown card’s theme becomes central to your campaign:

- Deepen the Concept:** Add layers to the initial interpretation
- Introduce Variations:** Create related but distinct elements
- Connect to Other Elements:** Tie it to other Crown aspects
- Evolve the Stakes:** Raise the personal and cosmic implications

Example: Pirate Queen Evolution

Season	Development	New Complications
Winter	Mysterious pirate captain with amber ship	Rival captains, mysterious cargo
Spring	Revealed as last Thalassian heir	Family curse, ancient bloodline duties
Summer	Attempts to harness deep current power	Moral conflict, player opposition
Autumn	Defeated but offers redemption arc	Future alliance possibility, changed motivations

Dynamic Campaign Timers

Timer Evolution System

Campaign timers should evolve as player actions change the world:

- Introduction** (0-2 segments): Threat becomes known
- Escalation** (3-4 segments): Threat gains momentum
- Crisis** (5-6 segments): Immediate danger to players/campaign
- Resolution** (7+ segments): Confrontation or transformation

sectionCreating New Timers

When existing timers resolve or become less relevant:

- tem Identify emerging themes from recent sessions
- tem Consider player actions that created new tensions
- tem Look for unresolved consequences from major choices
- tem Evaluate faction shifts and new power dynamics

sectionTimer Interactions

Advanced campaigns benefit from timer relationships:

- tem[Supporting Timers] One timer's progress helps another (Plague Spread → Resource Scarcity)
- tem[Opposing Timers] One timer's progress hinders another (Public Support ↓ Crime Rate ↑)
- tem[Cascade Timers] One timer's resolution triggers another (War Ends → Reconstruction Begins)
- tem[Hidden Timers] Progress tied to player ignorance (Ancient Awakening while players focus elsewhere)

LargeSession Zero Campaign Builder

labelsec:sessionzero

Session Zero establishes the creative DNA of a Fate's Edge campaign. This procedure provides structured steps for aligning tone, themes, factions, and player intentions. The goal is to merge character goals with the Crown Spread to produce a shared, coherent campaign vision.

largeOverview and Goals

A strong Session Zero ensures:

- tem Every character enters the world with meaningful motivations.
- tem The GM presents multiple, viable campaign seeds.
- tem Factions, threats, and relationships have clear starting points.
- tem The table agrees on tone, themes, limits, and expectations.

These steps fit on a single sheet and can be run in 4575 minutes.

largeStep 1: Character Intentions

Before discussing the world, define who the characters *want to be* within it. Each player completes the following:

- tem **Primary Goal:** A concrete objective for the first arc (e.g., "Track down the masked courier," "Clear my family name," "Unlock a forbidden ritual").
- tem **Secondary Goal:** A longterm or thematic desire (e.g., redemption, revenge, discovery, belonging).
- tem **Connection:** One explicit tie to another PC (debt, partnership, rivalry, obligation).
- tem **Personal Stake:** One thing they don't want to lose.

sectionCharacter Intentions Table

line Player line	Primary Goal	Secondary Goal	Connection
line			

This worksheet becomes part of the Campaign Dashboard (see Section ??).

Step 2: GM Campaign Seeds

The GM presents 35 seeds shaped around the setting and the group’s interests. Each seed should include:

- A clear conflict (“The Choir is building a new temple across the river.”)
- A moving faction (“The Amber Consortium is pressuring local merchants.”)
- A point of instability (“The King’s Inquisitors have arrived unannounced.”)
- A thematic hook (mystery, tragedy, revolution, cosmic horror, etc.)

Players vote on which seeds resonate most, then blend or refine as needed.

Step 3: Collaborative Crown Spread

Once a seed is chosen, the group performs a shared Crown Spread. This creates the foundational pillars of the campaign.

Procedure

- Draw the standard 5-card Crown Spread.
- For each card, ask: “How does this intersect with at least one PC’s goal?”
- Rewrite each card’s interpretation so it ties to a PC or faction.
- Pick 12 cards to elevate as Core Campaign Anchors.

Anchor Examples

- Suit of Chains (Reversed): A faction is secretly collapsing from within.
- Suit of Masks: A PC’s hidden identity becomes central to the plot.
- The Crown of Lanterns: Something longlost is awakening in the dark.

Step 4: Faction and Relationship Mapping

Now that characters and Crown Anchors are defined, establish the world’s starting state.

Faction Relationship Track For each major faction, mark its attitude toward the PCs:

3 Hostile 2 Wary 1 Suspicious 0 Neutral +1 Helpful +2 Allied +3 Invested

Prompt the table:

tem Which factions care about the PCs *right now*? tem Which factions have reasons to oppose or manipulate them? tem Which factions stand to benefit from the Crown Anchors?

sectionFaction Start Sheet

line Faction	Attitude	Current Agenda	Where They Touch PCs
line			
line			

largeStep 5: Tone, Themes, and Ethos Alignment

The GM presents 812 themes. Players each choose 23 that excite them.

sectionTheme Examples

tem Redemption and cost tem Masks and identity tem Cycles (seasons, sins, consequences) tem Power and corruption tem Faith vs. uncertainty tem Fractured legacy tem Broken oaths tem Ancient return

sectionGroup Alignment Questions Ask the table:

tem Should the campaign be more **emotional** or **tactical**? tem Are we comfortable with **moral ambiguity**, or should stakes be clearer? tem Should failure be **painful** or **graceful**? tem How much **mystery**, **politics**, or **myth** do we want?

Use answers to set initial **Campaign Themes** and seed the Resonance System (see Section ??).

largeStep 6: Safety, Structure, and Expectations

End Session Zero with clear agreements:

sectionSafety Tools

tem Lines and Veils (offlimits vs. fadetoblack) tem XCard or Script Change tools tem How to pause or reframe during intense scenes

sectionStructural Agreements

tem Expected session length and arc pacing tem How often downtime occurs tem Whether story beats accumulate across scenes or slowly reset tem How much spotlight rotation players expect

Outputs of Session Zero

By the end of the builder process, you should have:

tem A clear **Campaign Vision Statement** (13 sentences) tem A list of **Crown Anchors** tem Player **Primary and Secondary Goals** tem A **Faction Map** with starting attitudes tem A **Theme Set** for resonance tracking tem Established expectations and safety agreements tem Seeds for the first set of **Campaign Timers**

These can be formalized into the Campaign Dashboard (Section ??) and referenced at the start of each arc.

Dashboard Widget: Session Zero Summary

labelsec:dashboardszwidget

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Campaign Vision Statement

hantomXX

Crown Anchors (23 Key Cards)

tem hantomAnchor 1 Here tem hantomAnchor 2 Here tem hantomAnchor 3 Here

Player Intentions Snapshot

tem Primary Goals: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX tem Secondary Goals: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX tem Key Connections: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Campaign Themes (35)

tem hantomTheme tem hantomTheme tem hantomTheme tem hantomTheme

Starting Faction Attitudes

Faction	Attitude (3 to +3)
hantomFaction	hantomX
hantomFaction	hantomX
hantomFaction	hantomX

Safety Structure Agreements

tem Lines/Veils: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX tem Tools: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX
tem Playstyle: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX tem Session Length: hantomXXXXX

Tip: Keep this widget beside the Momentum Dial. Together they shape session tone and campaign direction.

Large**Advanced Threat Management**

large**Threat Ecosystem Design**

Create interconnected threats that respond to player actions:
section**Threat Categories**

line Category	Characteristics	Player Response
line Personal	Directly targets PCs/friends	Immediate, emotional response
Social	Affects communities/organizations	Strategic, diplomatic approach
Cosmic	Universal/supernatural scope	Mythic, philosophical engagement
line		

section**Threat Evolution Matrix**

line Response	Ignore	Oppose	Negotiate	Join
line Weakens	Grows stronger	Splits/retreats	Seeks allies	Absorbs influence
line Strengthens	Spreads corruption	Escalates conflict	Offers better deal	Demands loyalty
line Transforms	Changes nature	Reveals true form	Shows hidden agenda	Offers power
line				

large**Faction Dynamics System**

section**Faction Relationship Tracking**

Track faction attitudes on a 3 to +3 scale:
tem[3 Enemy] Actively working against player interests tem[2 Hostile] Will cause trouble when possible tem[1 Unfriendly] Suspicious and unhelpful tem[0 Neutral] Indifferent to player actions tem[+1 Friendly] Helpful when convenient tem[+2 Supportive] Actively assist player goals tem[+3 Ally] Will sacrifice for player interests

section**Faction Timers**

Each major faction can track:
tem **Influence** (06): Power and reach in the region tem **Stability** (06): Internal cohesion and resources tem **Agenda Progress** (08): Advancement toward faction goals tem **Player Relations** (3 to +3): Attitude toward player characters

Large Campaign Momentum Tracker

labelsec:campaignmomentum

Longrunning campaigns naturally rise and fall in energy. The **Campaign Momentum Tracker** gives you a simple, shared dial for that energy, helping you pace sessions, frame stakes, and decide when to push harder or ease off.

largeThe Momentum Dial

At the heart of this system is a single track:

Momentum Dial: 3 0 +3

tem[3 Stalled] The story feels stuck, players are reactive, threats advance unchecked.
 tem[2 Lagging] Progress is slow, stakes feel fuzzy, goals are unclear or too distant.
 tem[1 Drifting] Some motion, but no clear direction or urgency. tem[0 Balanced]
 Healthy rhythm of action, reflection, and downtime. tem[+1 Rising] Players are
 driving events, timers are moving, stakes feel alive. tem[+2 Surging] Big swings,
 hard choices, multiple timers near crisis. tem[+3 Overtimered] Everything is on fire.
 Climaxlevel intensity nearly every scene.

Keep the dial on a small index card or a corner of your Campaign Dashboard (see Section ??). Adjust it only when something *meaningful* happens; this is a coarsegrain tool, not a perroll modifier.

largeMomentum Triggers

Use the following as prompts, not rigid rules. When in doubt, adjust by +1 or 1, then wait a session to see if it holds.

sectionTriggers that Raise Momentum

tem **Decisive Victories:** Players resolve a major timer, defeat a key threat, or secure a powerful asset. tem **Major Revelations:** Secrets are exposed, hidden agendas revealed, or myths confirmed. tem **Bold Player Agency:** Players propose and pursue ambitious plans that reshape the situation. tem **Emotional Breakthroughs:** Significant character moments, reconciliations, betrayals, or confessions.

Each session, after play or during a break, ask:

“Did something happen that would make the world feel more unstable, intense, or in motion?”

If yes, nudge Momentum up by +1. Reserve a +2 jump for tectonic shifts (end of an arc, city in flames, a Crown suit fully claimed, etc).

sectionTriggers that Lower Momentum

tem **Downtime and Recovery**: Long stretches of training, healing, or quiet personal scenes. tem **Plateaus**: Multiple sessions where timers barely move and stakes do not escalate. tem **Loss of Direction**: Players are unsure what to do and keep circling the same options. tem **Resolution Without New Hooks**: A major conflict ends without clearly seeding the next arc.

Ask:

“Does the campaign feel like it is catching its breath, or wandering?”

If so, nudge Momentum down by **1**. A drop of **2** indicates a deliberate *season break* or time skip.

large**Mechanical Effects of Momentum**

Momentum should be felt, not just tracked. These are default guidelines; adjust to your table’s tolerance for swingy outcomes.

section**Difficulty and Position**

When Momentum is high, the world pushes back harder but also offers bigger payoffs. When it is low, danger is softer but progress is slower.

line Dial	GM Guidance	Mechanical Nudges
line 3	Soft framing, lots of safety nets	Lower DV by 1 for routine actions; timers advance only on Desperate failures.
line 2	Comfortable, reflective	Default to Controlled/Standard; only highrisk moves start at Controlled.
line 1	Slight drag	Occasionally increase DV by 1 when the world should resist change.
line 0	Baseline	Use normal DV and Position/Effect as per core rules.
line +1	Tense, alive	Default to Controlled/Standard; occasional free <i>increased Effect</i> on bold plays.
line +2	Edgeofseat	Raise DV by 1 for highstakes actions; timers advance on Mixed results as well as failures.
line +3	Whiteknuckle	Start most major moves at Desperate; consider double timer ticks on catastrophic failures.
line		

Use these as soft guidelines. You can also let players feel Momentum directly:

tem At +2 **or** +3: Offer occasional **bonus Story Beat (SB)** when they lean into risks that match campaign themes. tem At 2 **or** 3: Allow occasional **automatic success** on lowstakes, nondramatic tasks to avoid bogging down.

sectionNPC Reactions and Faction Behavior

Momentum also colors how factions and key NPCs move:

tem **High Momentum (+2 to +3)**:tem Factions take bolder moves on their turns (see Section ??). tem NPCs are more likely to escalate conflicts or push for decisive outcomes. tem New threats emerge more quickly from unresolved problems.

tem **Low Momentum (2 to 3)**:

tem Factions consolidate, dig in, or quietly scheme rather than act openly. tem NPCs stall, negotiate, delay, or ask for more information. tem Threats smolder rather than explode, giving players space to regroup.

largeUsing Momentum in Prep and Review

sectionBetweenSession CheckIn

At the end of each session, quickly answer:

tem **What changed in the world?** (Timers, factions, big events) tem **What changed in the characters?** (Arcs, relationships, corruption, assets) tem **Did the table feel hyped, tired, or mixed?**

If the answers point toward acceleration and excitement, consider raising Momentum by +1. If they point toward fatigue or drift, reduce by 1. If things feel exactly right, leave it where it is.

sectionSession Framing by Momentum

Let the dial suggest how to frame the next session:

tem[3 to 2] Start in a safe space: downtime scenes, sliceoflife, small mysteries. tem[1 to +1] Start in motion: travel interrupted, faction messenger arrives, a small but urgent problem. tem[+2 to +3] Start midcrisis: alarms blaring, attack underway, ritual already in progress.

When Momentum sits at an extreme for more than 23 sessions, treat that as a signal to either:

tem **Conclude an arc** (if high), or tem **Inject a bold new hook** (if low).

largePlayerFacing Momentum

Optionally, put Momentum in front of the players:

tem Include a small **Momentum Track** on your Campaign Dashboard handout.
 tem At the start of a session, say: *“We’re at Momentum +2; things are hot right now.”*
 tem Invite players to **call out moments** they think should shift Momentum up or down.

This keeps the table aware of the campaign’s “temperature” and reinforces that their choices, not GM whim, are driving the flow of tension.

If you are also using **Player Agency Points** (see Section ??), you can tie them together:

tem When Momentum rises due to a clearly playerdriven change, award **Agency Points** to the driving character(s).
 tem When Momentum falls because players chose rest, reflection, or repair, allow discounted or expanded downtime options.

Momentum and Campaign Phases

Combine the Momentum Dial with your **Seasonal Evolution Framework**:

tem **Winter (Establishment)**: Aim for 1 to +1. Too high and you rush past grounding; too low and the campaign never starts.
 tem **Spring (Growth)**: Float between 0 and +2, with occasional spikes.
 tem **Summer (Climax)**: Live at +2 to +3 until the arc resolves.
 tem **Autumn (Harvest)**: Drift back down toward 0 or 1 as consequences settle and new seeds are planted.

Treat these ranges as dials you can deliberately aim for, rather than passive outcomes. If you want to shift the story into a new phase, use Momentum as the lever.

Dashboard Widget: Momentum Dial

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Campaign Momentum

Large 3 2 1 0 +1 +2 +3

Current Level: hantomXXXX

At a Glance

tem **Low (3 to 2)**: Slow pace, introspection, safe moves, fewer crises.
 tem **Balanced (1 to +1)**: Default rhythm; normal DV and timer motion.
 tem **High (+2 to +3)**: Fast pace, aggressive threats, Desperate framing.

GM Prompts (Use During Play)

tem **Ask**: “Did the world heat up or cool down this session?”
 tem **Adjust**: Shift Momentum by ±1 after major developments only.
 tem **Apply**: High Momentum → escalate timers; Low Momentum → ease difficulty.

Micro Flowchart: Momentum Pressure

Upward (+)	Victories, revelations, bold plans, emotional shifts
Keep (0)	Mixed outcomes, lateral movement, stable stakes
Downward (–)	Downtime, drift, unclear goals, quiet arcs

Tip: Keep the dial visible on your Campaign Dashboard. Momentum is the fastest way to tune session tone and narrative urgency.

Large Advanced Player Integration

large Character Arc Management

section Arc Tracking System

Help players develop meaningful character growth:

- tem **Establishment:** Define character's current state and potential conflicts
- tem **Development:** Create opportunities for growth and choice
- tem **Crisis:** Present challenges that test character's core beliefs
- tem **Resolution:** Allow meaningful transformation based on choices

section Arc Trigger Events

Create mechanical hooks for character development:

- tem Moral dilemmas that challenge core values
- tem Relationships that create new obligations or conflicts
- tem Discoveries that change character's understanding of the world
- tem Consequences that force adaptation or growth

large Legacy System

Create lasting impact from player choices:

section Legacy Tracking

Document major campaign impacts:

- tem **Personal Legacies:** How individual characters changed the world
- tem **Faction Changes:** How major organizations were affected
- tem **World State:** Permanent alterations to the setting
- tem **Relationship Networks:** New connections and severed ties

section Legacy Rewards

Provide mechanical benefits for campaign completion:

- tem Starting assets for new campaigns
- tem Reputation bonuses with relevant factions
- tem Special knowledge or contacts
- tem Unique character options or backgrounds

LargeAdvanced GM Techniques

largeReactive Preparation

Prepare for player creativity without scripting outcomes:

sectionSituation Templates

Create flexible frameworks rather than fixed scenes:

tem[Social Encounter] Key NPCs, potential conflicts, information stakes tem[Exploration Challenge] Environmental hazards, discovery rewards, time pressure tem[Combat Scenario] Opponent capabilities, tactical elements, victory conditions tem[Mystery Investigation] Clues, red herrings, revelation triggers

sectionImprovisation Framework

When players surprise you:

tem **Identify Core Elements:** What must remain true for story coherence? tem **Assess Player Investment:** What aspects do players care about? tem **Find Narrative Hooks:** How can new elements connect to existing story? tem **Apply Mechanical Logic:** What rules support this development? tem **Maintain Momentum:** How to keep the story moving forward?

largeCampaign Pacing

sectionSession Energy Management

Vary session intensity to maintain engagement:

tem[High Energy] (23 sessions): Major conflicts, climactic scenes, critical choices tem[Moderate Energy] (34 sessions): Character development, investigation, relationship building tem[Low Energy] (12 sessions): Downtime, recovery, preparation, world exploration

sectionArc Structure Guidance

Multisession story arcs benefit from clear structure:

tem **Introduction** (12 sessions): Establish stakes and hook players tem **Development** (24 sessions): Complications multiply, alliances form tem **Climax** (12 sessions): Major confrontation, critical choices tem **Resolution** (1 session): Consequences, new status quo

LargeAdvanced Mechanical Integration

largeCorruption System Evolution

sectionTierBased Corruption

As characters advance, corruption becomes more complex:

tem[Tier III] Surfacelevel changes, minor abilities, social consequences tem[Tier IIIIV] Fundamental transformations, significant powers, world impact tem[Tier V+] Mythic alterations, realitybending abilities, cosmic significance

sectionCorruption Narratives

Connect corruption to character themes:

tem **Power Corruption:** Strength gained at cost of morality tem **Knowledge Corruption:** Wisdom gained through forbidden understanding tem **Survival Corruption:** Endurance through dark adaptation tem **Love Corruption:** Connection maintained through dangerous bonds

largeAsset and Follower Management

sectionPortfolio System

Organize holdings for easier management:

tem[Economic] Trade routes, businesses, investments tem[Political] Titles, contacts, influence networks tem[Military] Retainers, fortifications, strategic positions tem[Intelligence] Informants, research facilities, magical resources

sectionAsset Evolution

Allow significant holdings to grow in importance:

tem **Establishment:** Basic functionality and limited scope tem **Development:** Expanded capabilities and regional influence tem **Mastery:** Major impact and strategic significance tem **Legacy:** Permanent change to campaign world

LargeCampaignSpecific Tools

largeCustom Background Creation

sectionBackground Template

Create settingspecific character origins:

tem **Origin Story:** Where and how the character was raised/formed tem **Core Skills:** Two skills naturally supported by background tem **Key Relationships:** One ally and one rival with ongoing significance tem **Cultural Elements:** Unique customs, languages, or traditions tem **Obligations:** What the character owes to their background tem **Privileges:** What the character can expect from their background

sectionBackground Integration

Connect backgrounds to campaign themes:

tem Identify background elements that relate to current threats tem Create opportunities for background knowledge to provide advantages tem Develop complications that arise from background obligations tem Allow backgrounds to evolve based on player choices

largeRegional Customization

sectionCultureSpecific Mechanics

Adapt core systems to different cultural contexts:

- tem[Aeler (StoneBorn)] Emphasize engineering, contracts, and infrastructure
- tem[Lethai (Wood Elves)] Focus on nature, seasonal cycles, and rootlaw
- tem[Ykrul (Steppe Folk)] Highlight mobility, honor, and spatial reasoning
- tem[Kahfagia (Sea Folk)] Stress navigation, weather, and maritime law

sectionRegional Threat Adaptation

Modify threats to fit different environments:

- tem Desert: Heat, sandstorms, water scarcity, nomad conflicts
- tem Mountains: Avalanches, altitude, isolation, territorial disputes
- tem Forest: Predators,, spirits, resource competition
- tem Urban: Politics, crime, overcrowding, infrastructure failure

LargeAdvanced Storytelling Techniques

largeThematic Consistency

Maintain campaign atmosphere through consistent elements:

sectionSensory Details

Create immersive environments:

- tem **Visual:** Lighting, colors, architectural styles, movement patterns
- tem **Auditory:** Ambient sounds, speech patterns, musical traditions
- tem **Olfactory:** Scents, cooking aromas, industrial odors, natural fragrances
- tem **Tactile:** Textures, temperatures, weather effects, material qualities

sectionCultural Patterns

Establish consistent social behaviors:

- tem Greeting customs and social hierarchies
- tem Conflict resolution methods and legal systems
- tem Economic practices and trade relationships
- tem Religious beliefs and spiritual practices

largeMoral Complexity Framework

Create nuanced ethical dilemmas:

sectionDilemma Structure

Effective moral choices require:

- tem **Clear Stakes:** What is gained or lost by each choice?
- tem **Genuine Conflict:** Why isn't there an obviously right answer?
- tem **Personal Investment:** How does this affect the characters directly?
- tem **Lasting Consequences:** What changes based on the decision?

sectionConsequence Types

Ensure meaningful outcomes:

- tem[Immediate] Resolve within session (character fates, instant reactions)
- tem[Ongoing] Affect future sessions/campaign (reputation, political fallout)
- tem[Character] Personal growth/trauma, relationship changes
- tem[World] Setting permanently changed (Silkstrand’s fate, Choir’s influence)

LargeAppendix: Quick Reference Tools

largeCampaign Evolution Checklist

- tem[] Review current campaign timers and their interactions
- tem[] Identify emerging themes and player interests
- tem[] Plan seasonal developments for major elements
- tem[] Create new threats that respond to player actions
- tem[] Develop faction relationship changes
- tem[] Prepare character arc advancement opportunities

largeSession Preparation Template

- tem[] Review previous session outcomes and consequences
- tem[] Advance relevant campaign timers
- tem[] Prepare 23 potential scenes with flexible elements
- tem[] Identify player agency moments for each character
- tem[] Prepare Story Beat spend options for various outcomes
- tem[] Note connections to campaign themes and threats

largeThreat Development Matrix

line Threat Type	Player Response	Evolution	New Complications
line Personal	Ignore	Grows stronger	Spreads to allies
line Social	Oppose	Splits/retreats	Seeks new allies
line Cosmic	Negotiate	Shows hidden agenda	Offers better deal
line			

largeCharacter Arc Milestones

- tem[Establishment] Define current state and potential conflicts
- tem[Development] Create opportunities for growth and choice
- tem[Crisis] Present challenges that test core beliefs
- tem[Resolution] Allow meaningful transformation based on choices

largeCampaign Pacing Guide

- tem **High Energy** (23 sessions): Major conflicts, climactic scenes
- tem **Moderate Energy** (34 sessions): Character development, investigation
- tem **Low Energy** (12 sessions): Downtime, recovery, preparation

LargePlayer Agency Points

labelsec:playeragencypoints

Player Agency Points (PAP) represent the table's commitment to collaborative storytelling. They reward players for shaping the campaign through bold choices, thematic play, and actions that create longterm consequences. Unlike Story Beats (SB), which operate at the scene level, Agency Points operate at the *campaign* level.

largePurpose

The PAP system provides:

- tem A structured way for players to influence campaignlevel elements.
- tem A reward loop for thematic, characterdriven decisionmaking.
- tem A safety valve for stalled sessions or unclear narrative direction.
- tem A playerfacing counterpart to the GMfacing Momentum Dial.

Agency Points are shared by the **table** but earned individually, fostering cooperation while still highlighting player choice.

largeEarning Agency Points

Players earn Agency Points in four categories. The GM should award points sparingly; 12 per session is typical, 3 is a cap.

section1. Major Narrative Decisions Award 1 PAP when a player:

- tem Makes a choice that meaningfully alters the direction of the campaign.
- tem Pushes a moral, political, or personal conflict forward.
- tem Accepts meaningful consequences to advance the story.

section2. Thematic Alignment Award 1 PAP when a player explicitly engages with one of the campaign's established themes (see Session Zero, Section ??):

- tem Acting in accordance with a chosen theme.
- tem Leaning into a flaw or complication tied to campaign tone.
- tem Sacrificing advantage for thematic or narrative payoff.

section3. Crown Resonance When a character action directly invokes or complicates one of the Crown Anchors:

- tem Interacting with the card's symbol, omen, faction, or implied meaning.
- tem Escalating or transforming a Crownrelated situation.

section4. Bold Player Agency Award 1 PAP when a player:

- tem Proposes an ambitious plan with campaignaltering stakes.
- tem Initiates faction-level change or negotiation.
- tem Confronts a major NPC in a way that changes the board.

largeSpending Agency Points

Agency Points allow the table to shape the trajectory of the story without breaking the fiction or bypassing meaningful danger. Players may jointly decide when to spend PAP.

section1. Modify a Timer Outcome (1 PAP) After a timer advances due to player failure or faction action:

tem Reduce its advancement by 1 tick, *or* tem Move advancement to a different related timer (GM discretion).

section2. Influence a Crown Spread Draw (12 PAP) Players may request:

tem **1 PAP:** GM reveals one additional card before selection. tem **2 PAP:** Replace a drawn card with one from the top three of the deck.

This does not guarantee safety; it merely shifts emphasis or theme.

section3. Introduce a Campaign Element (2 PAP) Players add a new:

tem NPC, faction splinter, or minor location. tem Rumor, omen, or new thread that fits established themes.

The GM retains veto power if the addition breaks tone or contradicts lore.

section4. Trigger a Flashback Arc (3 PAP) Start a multisession or condensed flashback that:

tem Reveals character history. tem Introduces new lore tied to Crown Anchors. tem Recontextualizes an ongoing conflict.

section5. Stabilize a Campaign Thread (1 PAP) When an element risks being overshadowed or forgotten:

tem Freeze or preserve it in the fiction. tem Mark it on the Dashboard as "Active Thread."

largeLimits and Safeguards

To prevent metagaming or overreach:

tem PAP cannot alter **immediate** scene outcomes (that's SB territory). tem PAP cannot erase consequencesonly reshape their longterm trajectory. tem Players may not spend more than 3 PAP in a single session. tem The GM may pause PAP spending during climactic or lorecritical scenes.

largeIntegration with the Momentum Dial

Agency Points and Momentum mirror each other:

tem **High Momentum (+2 to +3):** PAP cost for introducing chaos is reduced by 1. tem **Low Momentum (2 to 3):** PAP cost for stabilizing or slowing down is reduced by 1. tem **At 0 Momentum:** No discounts apply.

This creates a pushpull economy where table desire and campaign rhythm influence each other.

Tracking Agency Points

The table keeps a single shared pool:

Agency Pool: hantomXX / Max 6

Players record individual contributions:

Player	Earned	Notes
line		
line		

Dashboard Widget: Agency Controls

[title=Agency Points (Quick Reference), colback=gray!10, colframe=black, fonttitle=, left=6pt, right=6pt, top=6pt, bottom=6pt, enhanced, sharp corners]

Current PAP: hantomXX (Max 6)

Earn When:

tem Big choices reshape the campaign. tem You engage core themes. tem You hit Crown Anchors. tem You propose bold plans.

Spend To:

tem Adjust a timer (1). tem Influence a Crown draw (12). tem Add a new campaign element (2). tem Trigger a flashback arc (3). tem Preserve a fading thread (1).

Tip: Use PAP to steer longterm narrative arcs, not individual rolls.

Regional Customization Workshop

sec:regionalcustomization

Regions in Fate's Edge are more than mapsthey are narrative engines. This workshop provides a structured procedure for designing unique regions with distinct culture, mechanics, and threat profiles. These steps help the GM create settings that shape play while remaining easy to run and flexible enough to adapt during the campaign.

Regional Creation Procedure

- Define the Region’s Identity Frame
- Establish Cultural Pillars
- Map Environmental Pressures
- Create Local Threat Templates
- Generate Regional Background Elements
- Connect Region to Campaign Themes and Timers

Each step can be completed in minutes, but together they create a rich, living region.

Step 1: Identity Frame

The Identity Frame defines the region’s core narrative role.

Choose 12 options:

- Frontier:** Untamed borders, new settlements, danger at the edges.
- Sanctuary:** A place of healing, tradition, or spiritual refuge.
- Engine:** A region that powers the worldtrade hub, port, forgecity.
- Cauldron:** Political, religious, or social tension ready to erupt.
- Relic:** Built atop ruins, myths, or the long shadow of forgotten empires.
- Threshold:** A region where two realities, cultures, or factions collide.

Step 2: Cultural Pillars

Define 35 elements that shape how people live. Use these pillars to influence NPC behavior, faction structures, and local beliefs.

Cultural Pillar Categories Choose or invent:

- Values:** honor, lineage, rebellion, knowledge, secrecy, hospitality
- Institutions:** guilds, temples, caravans, warbands, conclaves
- Practices:** rites, feasts, duels, pilgrimages, crafts, festivals
- Tensions:** class divides, magical taboos, ancient feuds, forbidden love

Pillar Template

Pillar	Description	Mechanical Impact
line		
line		

Step 3: Environmental Pressures

Every region is shaped by its environment. Choose the dominant environmental pressures and translate them into mechanical nudges.

Environmental Archetypes

tem **Desert:** Heat, water scarcity, sandstorms, nomadic routes. tem **Forest:** Predators, tangled paths, oldgrowth spirits, illusions. tem **Mountains:** Avalanches, altitude sickness, sheer cliffs. tem **Swamp:** Rot, disease, sinking paths, hidden fauna. tem **Urban:** Corruption, crime, overcrowding, infrastructure failure. tem **Coastal:** Storms, tides, piracy, sea spirits.

sectionEnvironmental Mechanical Effects Apply simple, narrativefirst effects:

tem **Position Shifts:** Start certain actions at Controlled, Controlled, or Desperate. tem **DV Adjustments:** Raise/lower DV for regionspecific hazards. tem **Emotional Tone:** Fearful forests, defiant mountains, suspicious ports. tem **Timer Pressure:** Fast timers during storms, slow timers during festival seasons.

largeStep 4: Local Threat Templates

Create 23 reusable templates for threats unique to the region.

sectionThreat Template Structure

line Threat Type	Description	Timer / Move
line Environmental Hazard	<i>E.g., shifting dunes, echoing forest spirits</i>	4segment hazard timer
line Social Instability	<i>E.g., labor revolt, cult infiltration</i>	Advance Faction Instability by 1
line Supernatural Pressure	<i>E.g., rift echoes, undead memory storms</i>	6segment threat timer
line		

sectionThreat Actions Threats act through:

tem **Pressures:** reduce resources, escalate conflict, demand choices. tem **Flares:** sudden, dramatic events that disrupt stability. tem **Omens:** warnings tied to Crown suits or local myths.

largeStep 5: Regional Background Generator

To ground PCs in the region, generate backgrounds with cultural and environmental hooks.

sectionBackground Elements Each background includes:

tem **Origin:** village, caravan, guild, monastery, ship, enclave. tem **Core Skills:** 2 skills reflecting upbringing. tem **Connections:** One ally, one rival. tem **Custom:** A unique practice, rite, or taboo of the region. tem **Obligation:** Something owed to the region (debt, vow, loyalty). tem **Privilege:** A benefit from cultural membership.

sectionBackground Template

line Element	Details
line Origin	hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Core Skills	hantomXXXXXXXXXXXX
Connections	Ally: hantomXXXXX, Rival: hantomXXXXX
Custom	hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Obligation	hantomXXXXXXX
Privilege	hantomXXXXXXX
line	

Step 6: Integrate with Themes and Timers

Tie the region to the campaign's Crown Anchors, themes, and timer systems.

Integration Checklist

- tem Connect at least one **Crown Anchor** to the region.
- tem Create 12 **Regional Timers**.
- tem Identify which factions' **Influence** or **Stability** rely on the region.
- tem Determine how the region's culture and pressures interact with **Momentum**.

Dashboard Widget: Region Snapshot

[title=**Region Snapshot (Quick Reference)**, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, font-title=, left=6pt, right=6pt, top=6pt, bottom=6pt, enhanced, sharp corners]

Identity Frame: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXX

Cultural Pillars:

tem hantomPillar tem hantomPillar tem hantomPillar

Environmental Pressures: hantomXXXXXX

Local Threats:

tem hantomThreat tem hantomThreat

Background Hooks:

tem **Origin:** hantomXXXXX tem **Obligation:** hantomXXXXX tem **Privilege:** hantomXXXXX

Regional Timers: hantomXXXXXX

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Obligation	hantomXXXXXXXX
Privilege	hantomXXXXXXXX
line	

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Identity Frame: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Cultural Pillars:

tem hantomPillar tem hantomPillar tem hantomPillar

Environmental Pressures: hantomXXXXXX

Local Threats:

tem hantomThreat tem hantomThreat

Background Hooks:

tem **Origin:** hantomXXXXX tem **Obligation:** hantomXXXXX tem **Privilege:** hantomXXXXX

Regional Timers: hantomXXXXXX

Legacy Creation Workshop

sec:legacycreation

The end of a campaign is not a closing door it is the moment the world crystallizes into memory and becomes the foundation for future stories. The Legacy Creation Workshop provides a structured approach to evaluate the campaign's impact, finalize irreversible changes, and carry forward the consequences into new arcs or new generations.

largePurpose

The workshop helps the table:

- tem Understand how the world has been permanently altered.
- tem Identify what the characters leave behind.
- tem Produce a "handoff document" for future campaigns.
- tem Translate narrative accomplishments into mechanical legacy.
- tem Seed new arcs with thematic resonance and clarity.

largeWorkshop Overview

- tem Legacy Assessment
- tem World Resolution State
- tem Character Epilogue Pathways
- tem Continuity Bridges
- tem Legacy Starting Packages
- tem Archive and World State Documents

Each step produces concrete material for a future campaign.

largeStep 1: Legacy Assessment

Review the following elements:

section1. Crown Anchor Resolution For each major Crown Anchor:

- tem Did its prophecy/theme complete, transform, or remain unfinished?
- tem Did it resolve peacefully, violently, or ambiguously?

section2. Campaign Themes (Resonance) Evaluate how each theme played out:

- tem Redemption, corruption, love, tragedy, destiny, revolution, etc.

Record whether themes:

- tem **Resolved** (closed arcs)
- tem **Echoed** (lingering influence)
- tem **Fractured** (unresolved or inverted)

section3. Momentum Arc Summarize the campaign's overall Momentum flow:

- tem Earlygame Momentum (tonesetting)
- tem Midgame Momentum (escalation)
- tem Endgame Momentum (climax)

This becomes part of the world's historical "feel."

largeStep 2: World Resolution State

Finalize worldlevel changes using the following categories:

sectionFaction Outcomes For each major faction, record:

- tem Influence (06)
- tem Stability (06)
- tem Agenda Outcome (completed, thwarted, redirected)
- tem NPC leadership changes
- tem Alliances or dissolutions

sectionRegional Shifts For each region:

- tem Major political or supernatural changes
- tem Environmental shifts
- tem Technological or magical advancements
- tem Emergence of new threats or mysteries

sectionWorld Timer Resolution Mark each major campaign timer as:

tem[Fulfilled] Its crisis manifested. tem[Averted] The crisis was prevented. tem[Transformed]
The crisis changed shape.

Step 3: Character Epilogue Pathways

Each player chooses one of the following epilogue paths:

section1. Quiet Ending The character retires into peace; gains:

tem A sanctuary location. tem A lasting bond with an NPC or faction. tem A
personal tradition that influences future generations.

section2. Continuing the Fight The character remains active and influential:

tem Gains a faction rank or title. tem Establishes a new organization or order.

section3. Ascension or Transformation For mythic or hightier endings:

tem Becomes a legend or guardian spirit. tem Alters reality in localized ways. tem
Leaves a relic or omen behind.

section4. Tragic Resolution A character may die, sacrifice themselves, or fall:

tem Leaves behind major unresolved threads. tem Generates a new threat or mystery.
tem Creates a new Crownadjacent artifact or ritual.

Step 4: Continuity Bridges

Continuity Bridges link the completed campaign to the next one.

sectionTypes of Bridges

tem **NPC Bridge:** A mentor, rival, or descendant returns. tem **Faction Bridge:**
A faction agenda continues or mutates. tem **Mythic Bridge:** A relic or prophecy
carries forward. tem **Geographic Bridge:** Return to the same region, now changed.
tem **Temporal Bridge:** Campaign jumps forward in time.

sectionBridge Generator For each major element in the previous campaign, choose one:

tem **Echo** (subtle reminder) tem **Return** (direct continuation) tem **Reversal** (for-
mer allies become threats) tem **Ascendance** (element grows in cosmic importance)

Step 5: Legacy Starting Packages

A new campaign may begin with specific advantages or disadvantages based on the previous one.

sectionTypes of Legacy Packages

1. Boons (Choose 12)

tem Regional stability or prosperity. tem Reputation bonus with a legacy faction.
tem Easier access to certain skills or talents. tem Legacy artifacts with narrative
power.

2. Burdens (Choose 1)

tem A returning threat. tem A fractured faction structure. tem A long shadow from a Crown Anchor. tem Cultural trauma or forbidden knowledge.

sectionStarting Mechanical Benefits

tem +1 to a faction relationship of choice. tem Unlock 1 **Background Variant** tied to the completed campaign. tem Access to 1 **Legacy Talent** (GM approval).

Step 6: Archive and World State Documents

Compile a permanent record:

tem Final Momentum summary. tem Crown Anchor resolution notes. tem Faction outcomes and new leadership. tem Regional maps with updated statuses. tem Major NPC fates. tem Legacy timers or unresolved echoes.

These documents form the opening chapter of the next campaign's guide.

Dashboard Widget: Legacy Snapshot

[title=**Legacy Snapshot (Quick Reference)**, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, font-size=10pt, left=6pt, right=6pt, top=6pt, bottom=6pt, enhanced, sharp corners]

Crown Outcomes: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Faction State: hantomXXXXXXXXXX

Major NPC Fates: hantomXXXXXXXXXX

Regional Changes:

tem hantomChange tem hantomChange

Legacy Boons: hantomXXXXXXXXXX

Legacy Burdens: hantomXXXXXXXXXX

Continuity Bridges:

tem hantomBridge tem hantomBridge

Appendix F: System Synergies, Scale Management, and Player Tools**CrossSystem Synergies**

labelappendix:crosssystemsynergies

Advanced campaigns rely on consistent integration across systems. This appendix formalizes the interactions between Assets, Political Intrigue, Patrons, Followers, Faction Turns, and Momentum/Agency economies.

Assets and Campaign Momentum

sectionAsset Evolution Triggers Assets grow or degrade when:

tem Momentum shifts by 2 or more. tem A faction advances or loses Stability. tem A regional threat reaches Escalation or Crisis. tem Players spend 2 Agency Points on Asset Development.

sectionAsset Integration Effects

tem Each Asset at Level 2+ grants **+1 Position** once per session when narratively justified. tem Political Assets can influence **Faction Turns**, modifying Influence by ±1. tem Cultural or mystical Assets can reinforce or distort **Campaign Themes**.

largePolitical Intrigue Synergies

Political Intrigue gains mechanical teeth through:

tem Momentum → shifts public sentiment. tem Agency Points → negotiate, blackmail, or expose truths. tem Faction Attitudes → political DV modifiers. tem Regional Pressures → spark intrigue events.

sectionPolitical Pressure Matrix

line Instigator	Pressure	Effect
line Faction	Stability Drop	Intrigue Timers +1
Region	Economic Shock	NPC Attitudes Shift
Player	Agenda Push	Momentum +1 or 1
line		

largePatron Synergy Framework

sectionPatron Demands Patrons react to campaign dynamics:

tem If Momentum is negative, they demand sacrifice or obedience. tem If Faction Stability drops, they offer dangerous bargains. tem If Themes resonate strongly, they bless or twist outcomes.

sectionPatron Boons When players align with Patron doctrine or fate:

tem Gain 1 Agency Point. tem Shift Position by +1. tem Unlock a shortterm Talentlike ability (GM discretion).

largeFollower Synergies

Followers gain or lose reliability based on:

tem Region stability. tem Campaign Momentum. tem Faction Attitudes. tem Player moral decisions.

sectionFollower Morale Track (2 to +2)

tem[2] Desertion risk; unreliable. tem[1] Fearful but present. tem[0] Neutral. tem[+1] Loyal; +1 Position when aiding. tem[+2] Devoted; perform selfless acts.

Large Campaign Scale Management

labelappendix:campaignscale

Fate's Edge supports stories ranging from quiet, intimate journeys to worldspanning sagas and generational legacies. This section provides tools for scaling the campaign without changing core mechanics.

largeScale Layers

section1. Intimate Scale Focus: relationships, trauma, recovery, community.

Mechanical Emphasis:

- tem Character Arc Triggers.
- tem Localized timers (4segment max).
- tem Social Position shifts matter more than DV.
- tem Faction dynamics are minimal or indirect.

section2. Regional Scale Focus: politics, travel, culture, mediumsized threats.

Mechanical Emphasis:

- tem Faction Turns.
- tem Regional Pressure tables.
- tem Momentum directly affects cities/regions.
- tem 6segment timers dominate structure.

section3. WorldSpanning Scale Focus: kingdoms, magical orders, international conflict.

Mechanical Emphasis:

- tem Campaign Momentum shifts trigger world events.
- tem Multiple Faction Turns per arc.
- tem Crown Anchors evolve or fracture.
- tem Longform 8segment timers.

section4. Generational Scale Focus: the long arc of legacy, bloodlines, myths.

Mechanical Emphasis:

- tem Legacy Packages.
- tem World State Documents.
- tem Continuity Bridges.
- tem Generational Talent Unlocks (GM option).

largeScale Transition Triggers

- tem Player goals exceed current scale.
- tem Factions unify, fracture, or ascend.
- tem Themes reach resonance 3+.
- tem Agency Point economy becomes too influential.
- tem A Crown Anchor shifts type (Suit → Mythic).

largeScale Tools

sectionScale Dial (03)

- tem[0 Intimate] One town, one family, one tragedy.
- tem[1 Regional] A valley, province, caravan route.
- tem[2 World] Nations, guild treaties, largescale magic.
- tem[3 Generational] Centuries, dynasties, cosmic myths.

The GM should announce scale shifts to align table expectations.

LargePlayer Handouts Package

labelappendix:playerhandouts

Playerfacing handouts ensure clarity, agency, and longterm campaign investment. These templates can be printed or inserted into digital character sheets.

largeCampaign Vision Document (Player Version)

[title=Campaign Vision Sheet, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, fonttitle=, sharp corners, enhanced] Campaign Themes:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Crown Anchors in Play:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Desired Tone and Mood:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

My Character's Personal Goals:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

largeCharacter Arc Worksheet

[title=Character Arc Worksheet, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, fonttitle=, sharp corners, enhanced]

Starting State: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Core Wound / Drive: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Arc Triggers I Want to Explore:

tem hantomTrigger tem hantomTrigger

Potential Crisis Points:

tem hantomCrisis tem hantomCrisis

Desired Resolution: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

largeFaction Relationship Guide (Player Version)

[title=Faction Relationship Guide, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, fonttitle=, sharp corners, enhanced] Major Factions:

tem hantomFaction (hantomAttitude) tem hantomFaction (hantomAttitude)

Where I Stand With Them:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

How They Might Help or Harm Me:

tem hantomHelp/Harm tem hantomHelp/Harm

LargeLegacy Planning Sheet

[title=Legacy Planning Sheet, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, fonttitle=, sharp corners, enhanced]

LongTerm Goals:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

NPCs or Factions I Want to Influence:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

What I Want My Mark on the World to Be:

hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Possible Legacy Boons or Burdens:

tem hantomBoon/Burden tem hantomBoon/Burden

LargeAppendix: Advanced GM Tools

This appendix provides fast, flexible, highimpact tools for running a Fate's Edge campaign with confidence, clarity, and dramatic consistency. These tools are modularthey can be used independently or as a full improvisational engine.

LargeImprovisation Deck System

labelappendix:improvdecks

Improvisation Decks are drawbased tools that inject uncertainty, texture, and thematic reinforcement without prep. The GM may print them physically, shuffle digitally, or use randomtable draws.

LargeComplication Generator Deck

Each card adds a twist when a partial success or player pause occurs.

sectionComplication Types

tem[Escalation] Threat advances; a timer ticks. tem[Reversal] An ally becomes a complicating factor. tem[Reveal] Hidden information surfaces prematurely. tem[Strain] Characters mark 1 Fatigue or lose Position. tem[Ill Omen] Crownrelated symbolism alters mood or destiny.

sectionQuick Table (1d6)

line 1	A threat evolves into something unexpected.
2	An NPC reacts emotionally or erratically.
3	A timer advances (GM chooses which).
4	A resource becomes limited, lost, or stolen.
5	A Crown symbol appears in an uncanny moment.
6	The environment shifts or becomes hazardous.
line	

largeNPC Reaction Deck

NPCs respond dynamically in advanced campaigns, especially during Political Intrigue or Faction Turns.

sectionReaction Types

tem Curiosity tem Caution tem Defiance tem Opportunism tem Admiration tem Fear

largeTheme Reinforcement Deck

This deck ensures your campaign’s themes remain visually and emotionally present.

sectionExamples

tem **Redemption:** A symbol of forgiveness appears. tem **Decay:** A structure collapses or reveals rot. tem **Destiny:** A prophecy shard manifests. tem **Love:** An old bond resurfaces in a new context.

largePlayer Motivation Prompts

Use these when pacing drags or players lose direction.

tem A friend is in dangerurgent call arrives. tem A faction seeks the PCs for an opportunity. tem A rumor surfaces tying directly to a PC’s Arc. tem A relic connected to a Crown Anchor surfaces. tem A moral crossroads presents itself.

LargeExtended Campaign Dashboard

labelappendix:dashboard

The Dashboard supplements the Momentum and Session Zero widgets with deeper tracking tools.

Timer Matrix

Organize all active timers and see how they interact.

Timer Name	Category	Segments	Interaction
	Threat	6	Advances with Faction Instability
	Social	4	Opposes “Rising Support” timer
	Mythic	8	Cascades into Regional Event

Threat Board

Each threat has:

tem **Name** tem **Category** (Personal / Social / Cosmic) tem **Current Timer State**
tem **Recent Mutation** tem **Next Move**

Momentum Flowchart

A quick visual guide:

- Momentum +1** → Faction goodwill, lower DV, allies appear
- Momentum +2** → Regional stability, access to rare resources
- Momentum 1** → Timers accelerate, NPCs cautious or fearful
- Momentum 2** → Regional panic, Patron demands, worldscale echoes

QuickBuild GM Templates

appendix:quickbuild

These templates allow rapid creation of scenes, NPCs, threats, factions, or regions.

Scene Template

Element	Details
Goal	XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Conflict Source	XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Complication Likelihood	Low / Medium / High
Emotional Tone	XXXXXXXXXXXX
Timer Impact	XXXXXXXXXXXX

Faction Template

Faction Aspect	Description
Doctrine	XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Leader	XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Influence / Stability	hantomX / hantomX
Active Agenda	XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
PC Relationship	hantomX

Conflict Triad Template

Define any conflict using:

tem **Pressure:** What "pushes" the PCs? tem **Temptation:** What "pulls" them offcenter? tem **Cost:** What must be risked to resolve it?

GM Emergency Toolkit

labelappendix:emergency

This is the core improvisation engine when players surprise you.

Emergency Procedure

When players go wildly offplan:

tem Identify the scene's **anchor** (motivation, NPC, tension). tem Draw from the **Complication Deck** or use the 1d6 table. tem Advance 1 timer or shift Momentum

by 1. tem Connect the new branch to a Crown Theme or Regional Pressure. tem Resume play with a single dramatic question.

LargeDramatic Question Examples

tem "What are you willing to sacrifice for this?" tem "Who do you trust right now?"
tem "What truth are you avoiding?" tem "What could go terribly wrong here?"

LargeOnePage GM Reference Sheet

labelappendix:gmreference

[title=GM Quick Reference, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, sharp corners, fonttitle=]

When in doubt:

tem Push Crown Themes forward. tem Shift Momentum by +1 or 1. tem Advance a meaningful timer. tem Offer a moral crossroads.

Scene Anchor (Choose 1):

tem Person (NPC desire) tem Place (environment pressure) tem Problem (threat or mystery)

Player Agency Hooks:

tem Offer 2 bad choices, 1 risky hope. tem Reveal a truth tied to their Arc. tem Give them control over a detail.

If pacing stalls:

tem Draw a Complication. tem Introduce a Faction offer or demand. tem Trigger a Regional Pressure (weather, omen, political shock). tem Let a Patron intervene subtly.

If overwhelmed:

tem Reduce the scene to 1 question. tem Close a timer early. tem Ask a player to contribute world detail. tem Take a 2minute reset break.

LargeAppendix: Practical Campaign Infrastructure

This appendix provides the structural tools a GM uses to maintain longterm coherence and player engagement across extended campaigns. These procedures reinforce Momentum, Agency, Faction Turns, and the Crown Spread while offering stability during unexpected shifts.

LargeScene Engines

labelappendix:sceneengines

Scene Engines are reusable templates that ensure scenes have direction, tension, and meaningful stakes. Use these to create sessions on the fly or stabilize improvised play.

ThreeVector Scene Engine

Every strong scene has:

- tem **A Core Desire** what someone wants.
- tem **A Pressure** what makes it difficult.
- tem **A Consequence** what happens if nothing changes.

Scene Vector Template

line Vector	Details
line Desire	hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Pressure	hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Consequence	hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
line	

Scene Turn Loop

Each scene follows a rhythm:

- tem Player declaration
- tem GM establishes Position and DV
- tem Roll + Outcome Matrix
- tem Advance one of:
 - tem Momentum
 - tem Timer
 - tem NPC Attitude
- tem Crown Theme

Environmental Generators

environment

Use these for expeditions, hexcrawls, travel arcs, or environmentheavy campaigns.

Environmental Pressure Types

- tem[Elemental] heat, cold, storms, earthquakes, tides
- tem[Ecological] predators, scarcity, disease, migration patterns
- tem[Mystical] cursed zones, ley surges, prophetic echoes
- tem[Civilized] borders, taxes, conflicts, infrastructure decay

Environmental Event Table (2d6)

line 2	A major environmental disaster reshapes terrain or stakes.
3	A faction exploits the environment for gain.
4	Harsh conditions force Fatigue or resource loss.

5	A strange omen tied to a Crown appears.
6	The environment mirrors a Character Arc theme.
7	Routine travelno event; Momentum drifts toward 0.
8	Discovery of shelter, blessing, or safe route.
9	A natural phenomenon complicates a current Timer .
10	A creature or entity interacts with party motives.
11	A resource or opportunity appears.
12	A surreal or mythic event alters destiny.
line	

LargeNPC Faction Lifecycle

labelappendix:lifecycle

NPCs and factions evolve through predictable phases. Use this to guide narrative arcs.

largeNPC Arc Stages

tem Introduction (identity, desire) tem Development (conflict or alliance) tem Tension (pressure or betrayal) tem Transformation (growth or fall) tem Resolution (lasting impact)

largeFaction Lifecycle

tem Emergence (new agenda) tem Influence (expansion) tem Crisis (internal or external) tem Resolution (reform, triumph, or collapse) tem Legacy (effect on the campaign world)

largeNPC Drift Mechanic

Between arcs:

tem Roll 1d6:tem[1] Drifts away; becomes inaccessible. tem[2] Suffers setback; attitude worsens. tem[3] No change. tem[4] Gains new influence or goal. tem[5] Strengthens ties to PCs. tem[6] Becomes key to next arc.

LargeMysteryBuilding Framework

labelappendix:mystery

Mysteries in Fate's Edge should focus on tension, discovery, and moral crossroadsnot puzzle solving. This framework ensures mysteries remain flexible and reactive.

largeThe Three Truths

Every mystery has:
 tem **Surface Truth** what NPCs believe. tem **Hidden Truth** what’s actually happening. tem **Human Truth** why it matters emotionally.

largeClue Types

 tem[Material Clue] object, mark, or physical evidence tem[Testimonial Clue] memories, diaries, interviews tem[Mythic Clue] dreams, omens, prophecies

largeMystery Failure Modes

If players stall:
 tem Reveal the next clue as a discovery. tem Advance a threat timer. tem Shift Momentum by 1.

LargeTravel Expedition Framework

labelappendix:travel
Long journeys are structured through:
 tem **Trail Events** (Environmental Table) tem **Travel Timers** (progress, danger, resources) tem **Rest Scenes** (Character Arcs, NPC bonds) tem **Landmark Encounters** (themes or factions)

largeExpedition Timer Types

 tem Progress Timer (to reach destination) tem Danger Timer (environment, creatures) tem Resource Timer (food, water, gear) tem Discovery Timer (secrets, sites, lore)

LargeRisk/Reward Matrix

labelappendix:riskreward
Use this to quickly evaluate outcomes of bold moves.

line Risk Level	Reward Potential	GM Guidance
line Low	Low	Keep stakes grounded.
Low	High	Add hidden drawback or future timer.
High	Low	Make moral or emotional consequences key.
High	High	Tie outcome to Crown Anchors or Themes.
line		

Large Campaign Drift Correction

labelappendix:drift

When a campaign loses focus:

1. Identify Drift Source

tem Too many timers tem Themes diluted tem Faction complexity overwhelming tem
Players unclear on stakes

2. Apply a Correction

tem Retire 12 timers. tem Reanchor to 2 Crown Themes. tem Clarify the stakes of
the next 2 sessions. tem Shift Momentum by +1 to encourage hopeful tone.

Large Downtime Engine

labelappendix:downtime

Downtime stabilizes pacing and amplifies character agency.

Downtime Actions

Each PC chooses 12:

tem Recover (clear Fatigue) tem Advance Project Timer tem Faction Work (raise
influence) tem Personal Arc Action (choose a trigger) tem Asset Development (level
or maintain)

Downtime Consequences

Roll 1d6 to see how offscreen events evolve.

line 1	A faction suffers instability.
2	A regional pressure intensifies.
3	An NPC drifts or changes attitude.
4	Momentum shifts toward 0.
5	A clue or opportunity emerges.
6	A Crownaligned omen appears.
line	

LargeRegion Transitions

labelappendix:regiontransitions

When moving between regions, determine:

largeTransition Steps

- tem What Crown Themes carry over?
- tem Which factions have influence in both regions?
- tem What environmental pressures shift?
- tem Does Momentum change due to local sentiment?
- tem Which PC arcs gain or lose relevance?

largeTransition Event Table (1d6)

line 1	A faction from Region A sabotages the move.	
2	The journey reveals a new clue or contact.	
3	Environmental disaster interrupts progress.	
4	NPCs from Region A send urgent news.	
5	Region B greets the PCs with hostility.	
6	A Crown omen marks the transition as destiny.	
line		

LargeAppendix: GM Cognitive Load Management Tools

Running a longform campaign asks the GM to track narrative, mechanics, emotion, pacing, and player expectations simultaneously. This appendix provides tools to reduce cognitive load, prevent overwhelm, support neurodivergent or fatigued GMs, and stabilize game flow during highintensity sessions.

These tools are designed to be:

- tem Lowprep
- tem Fastaccess
- tem Mechanically light
- tem Emotionally grounding
- tem Compatible with Momentum, Agency Points, Faction Turns, and Themes

LargeThe FiveMinute Reset

labelappendix:fiveminuterreset

A short, structured intervention when the GM feels overwhelmed or loses thread coherence.

Procedure (25 minutes)

- tem **Pause the table** (water break, stretch break).
- tem **Write one sentence** describing the current scene's intention.
- tem **Select one anchor:**tem Person (NPC motivation) tem Place (environment pressure) tem Problem (threat)
- tem **Choose one forward motion tool:**
 - tem Advance a timer
 - tem Shift Momentum by ± 1
 - tem Introduce a Crown omen
 - tem Trigger a character's Arc
- tem **Return with a single question:** "What do you do next?"

Why it works

It collapses hundreds of unseen details into one actionable step.

The 131 Improvisation Rule

appendix:131

A cognitive simplification for reactive GMing.

When you need to improvise:

- tem Describe **1 strong detail** (visual, emotional, or sensory).
- tem Offer **3 actionable paths** (choices, reactions, opportunities).
- tem Define **1 consequence** if nothing is done.

This keeps scenes dynamic without requiring full prep.

SingleGlance GM HUD

appendix:gmhud

A 4panel dashboard designed to be read in one glance, even during cognitive fatigue.

The Panels

Panel	Content
Now	Current scene anchor + 1 tension
Near	Next likely complication or shift
Fear	What the threats want right now
Hope	What the PCs deeply want in this moment

Use it as a bookmark, GM screen insert, or sticky note.

LargeThe ThreeSlot Memory System

labelappendix:threeslot

A GM should only intentionally track **three things at a time**. Everything else is optional.

largeThe Slots

tem **Primary Threat** (the thing pressing on the PCs) tem **Primary Relationship** (the most important NPC/P C bond) tem **Primary Mystery** (the unanswered question)

largeHow to use it

Everything that doesn't fit into these three slots becomes background texture.

LargeLowPrep Session Blueprint

labelappendix:lowprep

If the GM has no time, no energy, or no prep, this blueprint creates a full session in minutes.

largeBlueprint Steps

tem **One Location** (street, ruin, tavern, shrine) tem **One NPC** (desire + flaw) tem **One Threat** (46 segment timer) tem **One Crown Touch** (symbol, omen, echo) tem **One Character Spotlight** (an Arc trigger for someone at the table)

Run with the 131 rule for improvised scenes.

LargeDecision Throttling

labelappendix:decisionthrottling

A tool for reducing branching paths when players ask openended questions.

largeRule

Always reduce choices to:

tem[Two concrete options] (A or B) tem[One unknown option] (C: "Try something bold or unexpected")

This keeps the GM's cognitive load stable while maintaining player agency.

LargeEmotional Load Reduction

labelappendix:emotionalload

Long campaigns can become emotionally intense for GMs. Use these tools to protect bandwidth.

largeNPC Emotion Budget

At any given time:

tem Only 1 NPC may be highly emotional. tem 12 may be moderately emotional.

tem All others should be calm, neutral, or procedural.

This keeps roleplay sustainable.

largeConflict Frequency Cap

Limit intense emotional conflict scenes to:

tem 1 per session for small groups. tem 1 per 2 sessions for larger groups.

LargeSystemic Shortcuts

labelappendix:shortcuts

Tools for reducing multistep mechanical processes into onestep equivalents.

largeShortcut 1: Faction Turn Condensed

Instead of full turns:

tem Roll 1d6 per faction:tem[12] Stability drops. tem[34] No major change.

tem[56] Influence grows.

largeShortcut 2: Timer Compression

When overloaded:

tem Combine two small timers into one bigger timer. tem Or resolve a timer early using the highesttension outcome.

largeShortcut 3: NPC Memory Compression

If tracking many NPCs:

tem Reduce their state to a single phrase (e.g., "wants peace," "seeking revenge," etc.).

LargePacing Autopilot

labelappendix:pacingautopilot

When the GM is tired, choose one "autopilot mode." Everything in the session flows from that choice.

largeModes

tem[Conflict Mode:] Threats advance; timers tick twice as fast. tem[Discovery Mode:] Clues appear; lore reveals; mysteries open. tem[Connection Mode:] NPCs interact; arcs develop; relationships evolve. tem[Recovery Mode:] Healing, downtime, perspective shifts.

Pick **one mode** and let it run the session.

LargeSingleCard Session Prep

labelappendix:singlecard

Prep an entire session on a single index card.

largeThe Card

[title=**OneCard Session**, colback=gray!10, colframe=black, sharp corners, fonttitle=]
Scene Anchor: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Threat Timer : hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX
NPC: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Theme Touch: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX
Character Spotlight: hantomXXXXXXXXXXXXX

Use this for **lowenergy** days.

LargeGM CheckIn Questions

labelappendix:gmcheckin

Ask these privately before or after each session.

tem What do I want to feel in this session? tem What do I need from the players emotionally? tem What can I simplify today? tem What is one thing I can drop without harm? tem What is one thing that excites me?

LargeConclusion: Continuous Campaign Evolution

The most successful Fate's Edge campaigns are living stories that grow and change with player involvement. These advanced tools provide frameworks for that evolution while

maintaining the core principles that make the system special.

Remember that these tools are meant to support your storytelling, not constrain it. Use what works for your table, adapt what needs adaptation, and discard what doesn't serve your game. The goal is always collaborative storytelling where every player's choices matter and every consequence feels earned.

The expansion from "The Gilded Thorn" to "The Drowned Cure" demonstrates how these tools can support campaign growth from local adventure to worldspanning epic. Whether you're running a single session or a yearlong campaign, these techniques will help you create engaging, playerdriven stories that your table will remember for years to come.